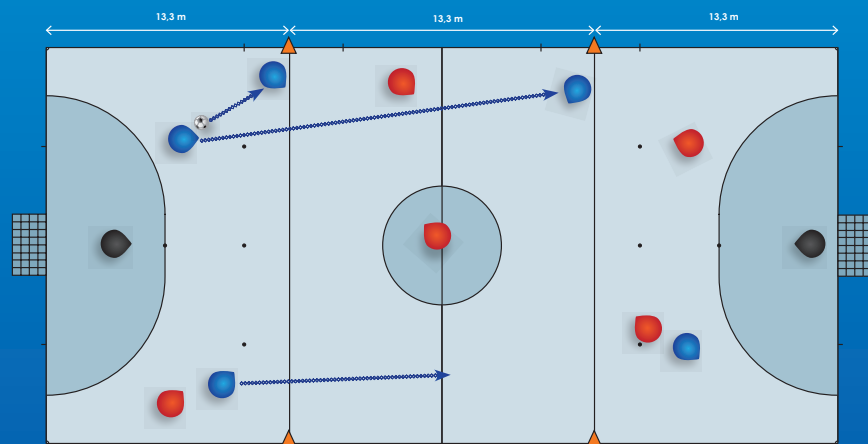


5v5 + goalkeepers in a 40x20m split into three zones of 13.3x20m with a maximum of 3v2 in any one zone

3

**LEARNING UNIT**

Core defensive and attacking concepts.

PHASE

Skills acquisition.

CONTENT

Floating cover. Dropping back. Buying time. Closing down passing angles, etc.

OBJECTIVES

To improve certain core defensive concepts when playing at a numerical disadvantage of 2v3.

NUMBER OF PLAYERS

10 plus two goalkeepers.

EQUIPMENT

Balls, bibs and cones.

DRILL DESCRIPTION

- 5v5 plus goalkeepers in a 40x20m area.
- Split the court into three zones of 13.3x20m. A limit is set on the number of attackers and defenders allowed in each zone. A maximum of three attackers and two defenders are allowed in each zone, but as long as this condition is met, the players are free to leave or enter each zone.
- Play is allowed to flow freely.

VARIATIONS

- Only allow two touches.
- The goalkeeper of the team in possession counts as an attacker in a 3v2.

Normally, the objectives for closing down the passing angles are: to prevent the attacking players from using space to their advantage; to prevent the opposition from moving the ball around the court (from the strong side to the weak side of our defence); to prevent the opposition from advancing with the ball (stopping them from breaking through our lines of defence); to buy time or prevent the opposition from creating a numerical advantage; to recover possession.

11. Dropping back

This is a basic core defensive concept which involves one or several players on a team dropping back into deep defensive positions after losing possession of the ball (defensive transition phase) or when the attacking team breaks with the ball beyond one of the opposition team's lines of defence (positional defence, usually pressing high up the court).

12. Defensive organisation

During any of phase of play and in assessing the options available to it, a team must organise itself so that it can make the most of its resources and make effective use of the other core defensive options open to it. This basic core concept forms the foundation for group tactics at a defensive level. The idea is not only to demonstrate positional organisation and the rational occupation of space in all situations and during all defensive phases, but also for the players to work towards a shared tactical objective (recover possession, close down the player in possession, maintain a balanced shape, etc.).

1.4 TECHNICAL ABILITY

1.4.1 Definition of technique

Generally speaking, the concept of technique within the world of sport refers to a process or a set of motor processes that enable proficiency to be gained in a particular sport. In futsal, players are often restricted in terms of the space and time available to them, which means that there is a lot of emphasis on the player's technical ability with the ball.

characterised by the repeated execution of an action as per the coach's instructions, and are not influenced by the presence or actions of opponents (focus on the player's ability with the ball and on exercises in pairs and groups).

Game-situation exercises always feature opposition, meaning that techniques must be executed in response to what the opponent does.

Furthermore, teaching methods must be tailored to suit the age group in question.

1.4.2 Technical ability and game situations

Being very skilful in terms of ball control is all well and good, but players must be able to apply this ability to a concrete, functional context involving team-mates and opponents, all operating within the spatial and temporal restrictions that characterise the sport of futsal. In other words, technical ability must be demonstrated in relation to the actual needs of the game. This is why the concept of 'technique applied to the game' is particularly important.

For players who are new to futsal, the emphasis must be on enjoyment, with players acquiring technical skills simply by playing the game.

Teaching core technical concepts means working step by step from the beginners', development, skills-acquisition and proficiency phases (in which basic skills are acquired and players are first exposed to competition) through to the refining and mastering of skills.

1.4.2.3 Pinpointing and correcting mistakes

When a coach seeks to correct a common error, they need to be able to break down the technique in question into the elements that make up a particular technical skill. For instance, when analysing a player kicking the ball, the coach has to focus on certain key aspects: the run-up; the player's standing foot; the foot used to strike the ball; the position of the upper body. The most common errors in these areas involve the angle of the run-up, incorrect placement of the standing foot and incorrect positioning of the torso and arms.

1.4.2.1 Developing technical ability

Mastering skills is generally based on the principle of repetition. However, in futsal, it is not possible to learn solely through a series of specific drills. The coach must also focus on other factors that have an impact on performance. Technical skills must be utilised pragmatically and must be adapted for use in constantly changing situations. In other words, technical ability is developed in a permanently evolving context (futsal is an 'open skill' sport).

1.4.2.2 Teaching technical skills

In general, when teaching technique, one must strive for a happy medium between a drill-focused approach and time spent on game situations. Drills are